

Nick Severson

Health & Benefits Strategist · Practice Leadership · Client Revenue Growth

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Health and benefits consultant with 10+ years designing and managing large-group health and welfare programs in brokerage and consulting environments. Trusted advisor to executive buyers, with a record of growing and retaining complex client relationships, generating new revenue, and building the tools a practice runs on.

EXPERIENCE

Director of Client Strategy

Sep 2025 – Present

James P. Bennett & Company

- Lead the employee benefits practice of a \$7M revenue regional brokerage: plan design, stop-loss and underwriting strategy, carrier negotiation, and executive consultation for 10+ large-group clients.
- Own book-of-business analysis, cross-sell, and pipeline optimization; built the practice's first AI-enablement strategy: an automation and audit engine that surfaced material client savings.
- Led the firm's first benefits captive funding initiative, building its workflows and SOPs from scratch.

Senior Client Manager

Mar 2024 – Sep 2025

Client Manager

Oct 2021 – Mar 2024

Nava Benefits

- Built the client-service model from scratch as the firm scaled Series A to C; hired, trained, and developed client-facing talent.
- Managed \$1.3M in revenue to the firm, delivering full retention, 5–10% expansion per account, and cross-sell and referral wins sourced from book-of-business analysis.
- Led renewal strategy, underwriting engagement, and stop-loss marketing for self-funded clients; alternative funding moves netted double-digit cost savings.
- Ran carrier RFPs, wellbeing point-solution carve-outs, and ACA/ERISA/5500 compliance audits.

Client Manager

Feb 2018 – Oct 2021

SCM LLC

- Consulted a large-group book of 15+ clients (200–2,000 employees) on plan design, compliance, and vendor strategy.
- Led C-suite renewal strategy, stop-loss marketing, and underwriting analysis across fully insured and self-funded plans; held full retention through 2020 and grew revenue 3–6% per client.

EARLIER

Account Executive, Jellyvision

Mar 2017 – Jan 2018

Account Executive, ITsavvy

Jun 2015 – Mar 2017

SKILLS

Large-group health & welfare plan design · Self-funding, captive & stop-loss · Underwriting & renewal modeling · Carrier negotiation & RFP marketing · ACA/ERISA/5500 compliance · Wellbeing & point solutions · Book of business, cross-sell & pipeline · New business development · Executive relationships · Excel · PowerPoint · Salesforce · AI enablement

LICENSING & EDUCATION

Health & Life Consulting, Employee Benefits License #0M27326 (CA)

Bachelor's Degree, Columbia College Chicago